

*Al
Mallette*

Top Company



Early Wynn, who joins Sandy Koufax and Yogi Berra as entrants into this year's baseball Hall of Fame, is a product of one of the Eastern League's vintage years.

Wynn was a young, rugged, hard-throwing righthander when he toiled for the Springfield Rifles in 1941—and off his 16-12 record for a club which finished dead last, you knew here was a guy who was going to make it.

Well, Wynn did. Despite three years of World War 2 duty (Wynn was organizer, manager and hard-hitting shortstop of the Manila Dodgers in 1945) the big man chalked up 300 major league victories.

On that same Springfield staff with Wynn was a chap named Jim Konstanty. And Jim really showed nothing with hit 4-19 record.

Twin Tiers fans have fond memories of that 1941 EL season. For one thing, Elmira finished third then swept through the playoffs—even winning one game, 1-0, over Wilkes-Barre after Red Embree had no-hit Elmira for 10 1-3 innings. The first hit did in Embree. Jess Pike powered a home run—and that led to what Bill Pope and Howard Pierce often referred to as Elmira's greatest baseball fish story. Clarence Pickerel was the winning pitcher, Pike hit the homer.

Sal Maglie, Tom Pullig and Ray Roche formed Elmira's Big Three mound staff. Ed Robinson, Andy Cohen, Alex Monchak and Frank Madura cavorted around the infield; Sammy Holbrook was the catcher; and Eddie Kobesky, Pike, Hubie Shelley and Willie Duke were the outfielders.

Present-day Elmiran Don Richmond was with Williamsport and missed by two points (.319

to .321) of matching Madura's league-leading bat average. Among the other standout pitchers that year were Alex Mustaikis, Sam Zoldak, Roger Wolff and Orrie Arntzen, all of champ Williamsport; Red Embree and Tommy DeLaCruz, of Wilkes-Barre, ex-Pioneer heroes Xavier Rescigno and Johnny Hvidos at Albany and Lew Krausse at Scranton; and Ellis Kinder and Mel Queen at Binghamton.

Bob Lemon was with W-B that year, Ralph Kiner was just feeling his oats at Albany and (Ed Netski note) Eddie Popowski was at Scranton.

That shows the kind of company Wynn was keeping in the 1941 Eastern. Look at Early today! Maybe the gates are opening a couple of years late for this great pitcher, but like Early said, "better late than never."

THIS IS ONE of the big nights of the season for basketball buffs. There's Academy-Southside in their 59th game at EFA . . . Horseheads-Edison in their plus-70th game at Edison . . . Hot shots Notre Dame and Waverly at ND . . . The annual East-West battle at Corning . . . A quick return between Towanda and Canton at Canton . . . And Wellsville's invasion of Bath to face the unbeaten Ramblers . . . Speaking of Bath, this ranks as one of the greatest sports seasons in Haverling history. Everybody's undefeated. That's what makes sports fun, eh, Steve Stricker?

I'M STILL trying to decide who dealt the most punishment over Super Bowl weekend—Joe Frazier or the Dallas Cowboys. You have to give Terry Daniels and the Miami Dolphins credit, though. They kept coming back for more .